CTIONS MADE FUN Dividing Fractio

A step-by-step lesson for primary students on how to divide fractions using the **Keep–Change–Flip** method.

1. What Is a Fraction?

A fraction represents a **part of a whole**. When something is divided into equal parts, each part is a fraction.

Term	Meaning	Example
Numerator	Top number – how many parts we have	3 in 3/4
Denominator	Bottom number – total equal parts	4 in 3/4
Proper fraction	Numerator < Denominator	2/5
Improper fraction	Numerator > Denominator	7/4
Mixed number	Whole number + fraction	1 and 3/4

2. What Does Dividing Fractions Mean?

Dividing fractions means finding out **how many times one fraction fits into another**.

Think of it like asking: *"How many halves fit into three quarters?"*

■ **Real-life example**
You have 3/4 of a pizza. Each person gets 1/2 a pizza's worth. How many people can you feed? Answer: 1 and 1/2 people!

3. The Five Steps: Keep–Change–Flip–Multiply–Simplify

1	**KEEP**	Keep the first fraction exactly as it is.	***3/4 ÷ 1/2 → Keep 3/4***
2	**CHANGE**	Change the division sign (÷) to a multiplication sign (×).	***3/4 ÷ 1/2 → 3/4 × ...***
3	**FLIP**	Flip the second fraction (swap numerator and denominator). This is called finding the reciprocal.	***1/2 flipped → 2/1***

4	**MULTIPLY**	Multiply straight across: top × top, bottom × bottom.	*3/4 × 2/1 = 6/4 (3×2=6, 4×1=4)*
5	**SIMPLIFY**	Reduce to lowest terms by dividing by the greatest common factor (GCF).	*6/4 = 3/2 = 1 and 1/2*

4. Worked Example: 2/3 ÷ 4/5

Step	Action	Result
1 – Keep	Keep the first fraction	2/3
2 – Change	Change ÷ to ×	2/3 ×
3 – Flip	Flip 4/5 to get its reciprocal	5/4
4 – Multiply	2/3 × 5/4 = (2×5) / (3×4)	10/12
5 – Simplify	Divide top & bottom by GCF (2)	5/6 ✓

■ **Final Answer: 2/3 ÷ 4/5 = 5/6**

5. Word Problems

Read each problem carefully, then use the Keep–Change–Flip method to solve it.

Q1. ■ **Chocolate Bars**
Priya has **3/4** of a chocolate bar. She wants to share it equally among **3 friends**. How much does each friend get?
Answer: ________________

Q2. ■ **Recipe Ingredients**
Arjun needs **2/3 cup** of flour. His measuring cup holds **1/6 cup**. How many scoops does he need?
Answer: ________________

Q3. ■ **Ribbon Pieces**
Meera has **4/5 metre** of ribbon. She cuts it into pieces that are **1/10 metre** each. How many pieces can she make?
Answer: ________________

6. Practice Problems

Solve these on your own using the steps you've learned!

Q1. 2/3 ÷ 1/4 = ______________	**Q2. 5/6 ÷ 2/3 = ______________**
Q3. 3/5 ÷ 1/2 = ______________	**Q4. 4/7 ÷ 2/5 = ______________**
Q5. 1/2 ÷ 3/4 = ______________	**Q6. 7/8 ÷ 1/4 = ______________**

7. Common Mistakes to Avoid

■ Forgetting to flip the second fraction	■ Always flip the SECOND fraction, not the first!
■ Multiplying the wrong fractions	■ After flipping, multiply top×top and bottom×bottom.
■ Not simplifying the final answer	■ Always check if you can reduce your fraction further.

■ Flipping the first fraction instead of the second	■ Only the divisor (second fraction) gets flipped.

8. Key Takeaways

KEEP	Keep the first fraction exactly as it is
CHANGE	Change the ÷ sign to a × sign
FLIP	Flip the second fraction (find the reciprocal)
MULTIPLY	Multiply numerators together, then denominators
SIMPLIFY	Simplify to the lowest terms

Answer Key

Problem	Working	Answer
2/3 ÷ 1/4	2/3 × 4/1 = 8/3	2 and 2/3
5/6 ÷ 2/3	5/6 × 3/2 = 15/12	1 and 1/4
3/5 ÷ 1/2	3/5 × 2/1 = 6/5	1 and 1/5
4/7 ÷ 2/5	4/7 × 5/2 = 20/14	1 and 3/7
1/2 ÷ 3/4	1/2 × 4/3 = 4/6	2/3
7/8 ÷ 1/4	7/8 × 4/1 = 28/8	3 and 1/2
Word Q1	3/4 ÷ 3 = 3/4 × 1/3 = 3/12	1/4
Word Q2	2/3 ÷ 1/6 = 2/3 × 6/1 = 12/3	4 scoops
Word Q3	4/5 ÷ 1/10 = 4/5 × 10/1 = 40/5	8 pieces

■ You've got this! Keep practising and fractions will feel like second nature. ■